

Fintech Competition Rubric: Advanced AI & Incubation-Ready Scaling

Focusing on proprietary tech moats, market localization, and incubation entry criteria.

Competition Deliverables

- **Incubator Investment Proposal:** Max 10 pages detailing proprietary AI methodologies, custom infrastructure architecture, and a commercial scaling roadmap optimized for incubators like UII Incubator or Dr. Ho’s Incubator.
- **Advanced AI-Powered Prototype:** Deployed application integrating custom server backends and functional agentic AI features.

Evaluation Matrix

Criteria	Weight	Venture Capital & Incubator Focus (Real-World & Practicality)
Proprietary Financial Intelligence & Data Moat	30%	* Alternative Data Mastery: Uses AI to scrape, analyze, and unlock value from non-traditional datasets (e.g., social media sentiment, web retail trends, utility footprints). * Risk & Personalization Utility: Translates data insights into actionable business advantages, such as proprietary credit scoring models, personalized investment engines, or advanced fraud detection.
Localized Technical Infrastructure	30%	* Solving Real Market Friction: Replaces rigid global sandboxes with a custom backend OpenAPI server or local enterprise API (e.g., UOB) to process native transactions natively. * API Architecture: Systematically exposes custom endpoints that deliver AI-processed alternative data straight to the frontend and conversational agents.

Agentic AI & Next-Gen UX	20%	* Frictionless AI Automation: Elevates the application experience using an advanced LLM agent (e.g., Gemini API) that moves beyond static chat to actively trigger transactions and call backend APIs via natural language. * Conversational Logic: Smoothly resolves user prompts regarding account status, complex financial calculations, or localized platform actions.
Incubation Target Readiness (Demo Day)	20%	* Incubator Viability: The team demonstrates high commercial viability, articulating an investment-ready pitch calibrated for accelerators like the UII Incubator. * Technical Defensibility: The architectural choices, localized compliance considerations, and AI implementations are resilient enough to handle production-scale financial operations.

Key Adjustments for the Competition Format:

- **Shift from Grades to Moats:** Academic requirements for documentation are replaced by evaluations of the startup's "Technical Defensibility" and "Data Moats".
- **Localization Priority:** Teams are heavily incentivized to fix systemic operational limitations (such as global API currency bugs) by creating custom backend servers tailored specifically to their regional target markets.
- **Incubation Focus:** The traditional "Future Roadmap" section is adapted directly into an active evaluation of incubation readiness, preparing the founders to pitch face-to-face against institutional criteria.